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BATTERY POWER MANAGEMENT APPARATUS AND METHOD

Abstract

An apparatus, including: a first circuit containing a first load, wherein a first battery is associated with the first circuit; a second circuit containing a second load, wherein the second load draws current from a second battery when the first load is not operating or is non-operational; a first switch, wherein the first switch is capable of disconnecting the first battery from the first circuit; a second switch, wherein the second switch is capable of connecting the first battery to the first circuit, wherein the first switch and the second switch are connected in series; at least one recharger, wherein the at least one recharger recharges the first battery and the second battery when the first load is operating; a third circuit containing a second battery; and a third load. The third load is connected between the first circuit and the third circuit.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/232,578, filed Aug. 10, 2023, and entitled “BATTERY POWER MANAGEMENT APPARATUS AND METHOD”, the subject matter and teachings of which are hereby incorporated by reference herein in their entirety, which application is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/544,983, filed Dec. 8, 2021, and entitled “BATTERY POWER MANAGEMENT APPARATUS AND METHOD”, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,760,227, the subject matter and teachings of which are hereby incorporated by reference herein in their entirety. U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/544,983 claims the benefit of the priority of U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 63/149,530, filed Feb. 15, 2021, and entitled “BATTERY POWER MANAGEMENT APPARATUS AND METHOD”, the subject matter and teachings of which are hereby incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

[0002] The present invention pertains to a battery power management apparatus and method and, in particular, to a battery power management apparatus and method which can conserve battery power and/or battery charge level for electrical systems and/or components which do not require power when a vehicle, a premises, or an article, is not operating or not in use, while providing power to and/or for electrical systems and/or components which require power when the vehicle, the premises, or the article, is not operating or not in use, or which otherwise need to be provided with power when a power source and/or a battery recharging source ceases to operate or is not operational, and/or the present invention pertains to a battery power management apparatus and method which can be utilized to generate electric power so as to recharge a battery or batteries of an electric vehicle or a hybrid vehicle, of any type or kind, while the electric vehicle or the hybrid is in use or operating, as well as which can be utilized to conserve battery power and/or battery charge level for an electric vehicle or a hybrid vehicle, of any type or kind, as well as for any electrical systems and/or components of the same, which do not require power when the electric vehicle or the hybrid vehicle is not operating or not in use, while providing power to and/or for electrical systems and/or components which require power when the electric vehicle or the hybrid vehicle is not operating or not in use, or which otherwise need to be provided with power when a power source and/or a battery recharging source ceases to operate or is not operational.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

[0003] Batteries and direct current (DC) power sources are utilized in many applications. Perhaps one of the most common uses of batteries and DC power sources is in automobiles. Typically, a vehicle battery provides the power which powers the vehicle's ignition system and a vehicle alternator generates electrical power when the vehicle's engine is operating which power can be utilized to provide the electrical power for many of a wide variety of vehicle systems, equipment systems, and/or components, along with electrical power to charge the vehicle battery.

[0004] As many who own a vehicle will readily understand, there are a number of vehicle systems, equipment systems, or components, such as, but not limited to, anti-theft systems, RF systems which operate in connection with remote control door lock openers, electronic command computers, radio clocks, and any other systems, equipment systems, or components, which require power when the vehicle is not operating, not in use, or when the engine is not operating or is not running. These vehicle systems, equipment systems, or components, which require power when the vehicle is not operating, not in use, or when the engine is not operating or is not running, presents which some may call drain or a “parasitic drain” on the vehicle battery. This drain or “parasitic drain” on the vehicle battery can deplete the vehicle's battery of its charge to a point where the battery either goes dead or does not have sufficient power to start the vehicle and/or to ensure that all vehicle systems, equipment systems, or components, are fully powered.

[0005] Disconnecting a vehicle's battery when the vehicle is not in use can serve to reserve the battery charge and/or power level, but such disconnecting of the battery deprives those vehicle systems, equipment systems, or components, which require power when the vehicle is not operating, not in use, or when the engine is not operating or is not running, of power and thereby shutting the same down. The shutting down of a vehicle's command computer, anti-theft system, radio clock, or dashboard gauges, or any other systems, equipment systems, or components, is not desirable. While vehicles are designed and built to accommodate these drains and/or “parasitic drains” on the vehicle battery when the vehicle is not operating, not in use, or when the engine is not operating or is not running, sometimes these drains or “parasitic drains” can cause a battery to lose its charge or “go dead”. Sometimes these drains are also caused by short circuits in a vehicle electric circuit, and the diagnosing and repair of same can be very time consuming and expensive.

[0006] Similar drains or “parasitic drains” can also be found in DC circuits utilized in any type or kind of vehicles, land vehicles, automobiles, trucks, recreational vehicles, boats, marine vessels, submarines, aircraft, airplanes, jets, helicopters, spacecraft, space shuttles, recreational vehicles, motorcycles, scooters, or any other type or kind of vehicle, any type or kind of premises, residential premises, commercial premises, equipment, of any system, equipment system, or component, of, in, or associated with, same, or any article which may utilize a DC power source.

[0007] Other problems can also arise when a vehicle power source or battery recharging device or source ceases to operate or is not operational, or is turned off, suddenly, unintentionally, or otherwise. For example, certain vehicles utilize alternators in order to provide power to certain of the vehicle's systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, and in order to recharge the vehicle battery, when the vehicle engine is running. The alternator might provide power to any number of vehicle systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, as well as recharge the vehicle battery when the engine is running, but the alternator stops doing so when the vehicle engine stops running or is turned off. When this occurs, those vehicle systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, which are powered by the alternator, lose power and become non-operational. These vehicle systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, can include the vehicle's power steering system, the vehicle's power brakes system, the vehicle's traction control system, the vehicle's electronic stability control system, the vehicle's anti-lock brake system, the vehicle's safety systems, the vehicle's lights, the vehicle's power door locks or vehicle power door lock systems, the vehicle's airbag systems, the vehicle's passenger restraint systems, the vehicle's supplemental restraint systems, the vehicle's communication systems, the vehicle's emergency communication systems, among others. Any loss of power to these vehicle systems, equipment systems, devices, or components can result in accidents which can cause serious injury or even death.

[0008] Similar loss of power problems can also be found in AC and/or DC circuits utilized in any type or kind of vehicles, land vehicles, automobiles, trucks, recreational vehicles, boats, marine vessels, submarines, aircraft, airplanes, jets, helicopters, spacecraft, space shuttles, recreational vehicles, motorcycles, scooters, or any other type or kind of vehicle, any type or kind of premises,

residential premises, commercial premises, equipment, of any system, equipment system, or component, of, in, or associated with, same, or any article which may utilize a DC power source or battery in connection with a power source such as a generator or alternator which can provide power to certain systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, and/or which may also serve to recharge the DC power source or battery.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0009] The present invention pertains to a battery power management apparatus and method and, in particular, to a battery power management apparatus and method which can conserve battery power and/or battery charge level for electrical systems and/or components which do not require power when a vehicle, a premises, or an article, is not operating or not in use, while providing power to and/or for electrical systems and/or components which require power when the vehicle, the premises, or the article, is not operating or not in use, or which otherwise needs to be provided with power when a power source and/or a recharging source ceases to operate, is non-operational, or is turned off, and/or the present invention pertains to a battery power management apparatus and method which can be utilized to generate electric power so as to recharge a battery or batteries of an electric vehicle or a hybrid vehicle, of any type or kind, while the electric vehicle or the hybrid is in use or operating, as well as which can be utilized to conserve battery power and/or battery charge level for an electric vehicle or a hybrid vehicle, of any type or kind, as well as for any electrical systems and/or components of the same, which do not require power when the electric vehicle or the hybrid vehicle is not operating or not in use, while providing power to and/or for electrical systems and/or components which require power when the electric vehicle or the hybrid vehicle is not operating or not in use, or which otherwise need to be provided with power when a power source and/or a battery recharging source ceases to operate or is not operational, which overcomes the shortfalls of the prior art.

[0010] The apparatus and method of the present invention can be utilized in any number of a wide variety of applications, including but not limited to, applications in, or in connection with, motor vehicles, automobiles, trucks, mass transportation vehicles, buses, school buses, trains, subway trains, aircraft, airplanes, jets, gliders, hot air balloons, spacecraft, space shuttles, satellites, boats, marine vehicles, marine vessels, submarines, motorcycles, motor scooters, recreational vehicles (RVs) of any type or kind, mobile homes, jet skis, equipment of any kind or type, or any other vehicle (hereinafter referred to as a “vehicle” or “vehicles”), or in applications in, or in connection with, premises, residential premises, commercial premises, buildings, structures, land, or any land and/or structure of any type or kind (hereinafter referred to as a “premises” or “premises”), or in applications in, with, or in connection with, any article or device (hereinafter “article” or “articles”) which utilizes a battery or a DC power source and which is also equipped for, adapted for, or capable of, recharging that battery or DC power source. The apparatus and method of the present invention can be utilized in connection with gasoline-powered vehicles, diesel-powered vehicles, or any other fuel-powered vehicles, combustion engine powered vehicles, electric-powered vehicles, hybrid-powered vehicles, or any other types or kinds of vehicles.

[0011] The apparatus of the present invention can be utilized in, on, or in connection with, or can be adapted for and utilized in, on, or in connection with, any of the herein-identified and/or herein-defined vehicles, premises, or articles.

[0012] The apparatus includes a primary vehicle battery which can be connected to or with, or which is connectable to and/or with, the vehicle ignition system as well as any other vehicle electrical system or device or vehicle electronic system or device of the vehicle and which does not draw electrical power or current when the vehicle or the vehicle ignition system is not in use (hereafter collectively referred to as “non-drain loads”). The primary vehicle battery can be any battery or DC power source which is suitable for use in, on, or in connection with, the particular vehicle.

[0013] The primary vehicle battery can be electrically connected with, or coupled to, the vehicle

ignition system in any appropriate circuit configuration, such as, but not limited to, a parallel connection or a series connection, or any combination of same, and to any number of any of the other non-drain loads in, on, or of, the vehicle in any appropriate circuit configuration, such as, but not limited to, a parallel connection or a series connection. The vehicle non-drain loads can be any electrical circuit, system, equipment system, device, or component, which requires electrical power when the vehicle, or any electrical circuit, system, equipment system, device, or component, is in use or is being operated.

[0014] The apparatus also includes a main cutoff switch which can be connected in series with the primary vehicle battery. The main cutoff switch can serve to disconnect the primary vehicle battery from all vehicle circuits and/or devices including, but not limited to, the vehicle ignition system and the vehicle non-drain loads. In this regard, the cutoff switch can be utilized to completely and electrically disconnect the primary vehicle battery from any and all loads in, on, or connected with, the vehicle.

[0015] The main cutoff switch can be a manual switch which can be placed at any suitable or convenient location in or on the vehicle and/or the main cutoff switch can also be a remotely controlled switch, such as those typically utilized in connection with remote controlled vehicle starters or remote controlled vehicle ignition systems. In this regard, a remote control device can be utilized to transmit, via a transmitter, a radio frequency (RF) signal, an infrared (IR) signal, or any other suitable signal, or communication transmission, which can be received by a corresponding receiver in, on, or at the vehicle, which can be processed by a receiver or any other appropriate controller, control device, computer, or other device, which can cause the main cutoff switch to close in order to remotely enable the vehicle to be utilized, or can cause the main cutoff switch to open so as to disable vehicle operation.

[0016] The apparatus can also include a vehicle ignition/On switch, which can be connected in series with the primary vehicle battery and which can be utilized to electrically connect or electrically disconnect the primary vehicle battery to or from each of to the vehicle ignition system and/or to or from each of any number of the non-drain loads. The vehicle ignition/On switch can also be utilized to selectively activate the vehicle ignition system in order to start the vehicle engine and/or to activate, and/or to enable an activation of, any one or more of any of the vehicles systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, and/or any vehicle non-drain loads, of the vehicle and/or to activate, and/or to enable the activation of, any one or more of the electrical circuits, systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, and/or any vehicle non-drain loads, of the vehicle which require electrical power for use or operation.

[0017] The vehicle ignition/On switch can be a manual switch, such as those which are typically utilized in connection with a vehicle key and/or the vehicle ignition/On switch can also be a remotely controlled switch, such as those typically utilized in connection with remote controlled vehicle starters or remote controlled vehicle ignition systems. In this regard, a remote control device can be utilized to transmit, via a transmitter, a radio frequency (RF) signal, an infrared (IR) signal, or any other suitable signal, or communication transmission, which can be received by a corresponding receiver in, on, or at the vehicle, which can be processed by the receiver or any other appropriate controller, control device, computer, or other device, which can cause the vehicle ignition/On switch to close in order to remotely start the vehicle's engine or can, in and under appropriate and safe circumstances, such when the vehicle engine is off, cause the vehicle ignition/On switch to open so as to disable vehicle operation.

[0018] The apparatus also includes a vehicle auxiliary battery which can be the same as, or can be of the same type or kind of battery or DC power source as the primary vehicle battery. Both of the primary vehicle battery and the vehicle auxiliary battery can be **12** volt automobile batteries, in the case where the vehicle is an automobile, which can have similar, if not identical, specifications and which can be recharged from, by, with, or using, the same electrical vehicle alternator described herein. The vehicle auxiliary battery can be connected in series or in parallel with each of all of the

vehicle devices, equipment, equipment systems, or components, which typically drain current from a vehicle battery when the vehicle of the vehicle ignition systems is not operation or “off” (hereinafter collectively referred to as the “drain loads”).

[0019] The drain loads can include, for example, but are not limited to, the vehicle command computer or command computers, any computers or devices which require to be electrically powered at all times, the vehicle anti-theft system or vehicle theft-deterrent system which require to be electrically powered at all times, the remote power door locking/unlocking system and any receivers and/or computers or processing devices associated with same which require electrical power at all times, the vehicle remote starter system and any receivers and/or computers or processing devices associated with same which require electrical power at all times, the vehicle radio clock, the vehicle radio memory system, any computers or devices having or utilizing memory or any other processing capabilities which require power at all times, any gauges or associated coils which require at least some electrical power at all times to remain properly functional, and any other vehicle systems, equipment systems, components, or devices, which require electrical power at all times. In this regard, the drain loads can include, but are not limited to, a vehicle anti-theft system, a vehicle radio memory storage system or device, a radio clock, any command computer or command computers, remote door opening systems, or devices, remote control systems or devices, or any other systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, which are known to drain electrical power at all times and which can drain a vehicle battery of current and deplete its charge or charge level when a vehicle is typically not in use or is not operating.

[0020] The apparatus can also be connected to or with the vehicle alternator, which alternator is typically equipped to, and also used in order to, perform a number of functions including, but not limited to, recharging the battery of a vehicle, and which can be utilized in the apparatus of the present invention in order to continuously re-charge each of the primary vehicle battery and the vehicle auxiliary battery of the apparatus of the present invention. A single vehicle alternator can be used to recharge both the primary vehicle battery and the vehicle auxiliary battery. Two alternators can also be utilized so that one alternator can be utilized to charge the primary vehicle battery and so that the other alternator can be utilized to charge the vehicle auxiliary battery. Any pertinent circuits, components, or devices, of the alternator can be connected between each respective electrical circuit or connector(s) associated with the recharging of each of the primary vehicle battery and the vehicle auxiliary battery and a ground as needed or desired. In a preferred embodiment, the apparatus can also be connected to the ground as needed or desired.

[0021] In an embodiment in which two alternators are employed, one of the alternators can be dedicated for performing all of the functions of a typical vehicle alternator as well as, and including, recharging the primary vehicle battery and providing electrical power to the vehicle ignition system, the vehicle non-drain loads, or any electrical circuit, system, equipment system, device, or component, of the vehicle which requires electrical power when the vehicle, or any electrical circuit, system, equipment system, device, or component, is in use or is being operated, while the second alternator can be dedicated for recharging the vehicle auxiliary battery and, if needed or desired, for performing any other functions such as providing electrical power to any of the drain loads of the vehicle. In an embodiment in which two alternators are utilized, the first alternator can be connected to vehicle ground and to each of the various vehicle electrical circuits needed for providing any needed electrical power to the various electrical circuits, systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, of, in, on, or associated with, the vehicle and for recharging the primary vehicle battery, while the second alternator can be connected to vehicle ground and to any vehicle electrical circuit(s) needed for recharging the vehicle auxiliary battery as well as to any other electrical circuit(s) for which the second alternator is being utilized to supply electrical power.

[0022] The apparatus can also be utilized in order to remotely open or to remotely close each of the

main cutoff switch and the vehicle ignition/On switch. In such an embodiment, the apparatus can include a transmitter, which can be any type or kind of remote control transmitter for opening or closing the circuit controlled by the main cutoff switch and which can be integrated into and/or with a vehicle remote control device, a key chain, or a key fob, or any other device, a receiver located at, in, or on, the vehicle, for receiving a signal, signals, or sequence of signals, transmitted from the transmitter and indicative of a main shutoff switch opening operation or a main cutoff switch closing operation, a controller for processing any signal, signals, or sequence of signals, received by the receiver, and an electronically activated switching device which can be located in parallel with the main cutoff switch, which can serve to close or open the circuit controlled by the main cutoff switch. The electronically activated switching device can be placed in parallel with the main cutoff switch so that it can simply bypass the main cutoff switch.

[0023] The apparatus can also include a transmitter, which can be any type or kind of remote control transmitter for opening or closing the circuit controlled by the vehicle ignition/On switch and which can also be integrated into and/or with a vehicle remote control device, a key chain, or a key fob, or any other device, a receiver located at, in, or on, the vehicle, for receiving a signal, signals, or sequence of signals, transmitted from the transmitter and indicative of a vehicle ignition switch opening operation or a vehicle ignition switch closing operation, a controller for processing any signal, signals, or sequence of signals, received by the receiver, and an electronically activated switching device which can be located in parallel with the vehicle ignition/On switch, which can serve to close or open the circuit controlled by the vehicle ignition/On switch. The electronically activated switching device can be placed in parallel with the vehicle ignition/On switch so that it can simply bypass the vehicle ignition/On switch.

[0024] The above-described transmitters can also be implemented by, replaced by, or used in conjunction with, a central processing computer or an Internet server which can be associated with a web site. Any authorized user or authorized person can utilize any suitable communication device, which can be a personal computer, a tablet, a tablet computer, a laptop computer, a notebook computer, a cellular telephone, a wireless telephone, a personal digital assistant, or any other suitable device, in order to transmit any respective signal, signals, or sequence of signals, to a respective receiver via the central processing computer on, over, or via, the Internet and/or the World Wide Web, and/or on or over any other communication network(s), wireless communication network(s), or any combination of same. In this regard, any authorized user or authorized person can use or control the apparatus of the present invention on, over, or via, the Internet and/or the World Wide Web and/or any other communication network(s), wireless communication network(s), or any combination of same.

[0025] The apparatus of the present invention can be utilized to provide and to perform battery power management in and for any of the herein-described vehicles, premises, or articles, by providing, and/or by allowing for, the electrical powering of any electrical devices, which typically require electrical power at all times and/or when the respective vehicle, premises, or article, is not in use, while, at the same time, conserving the power of the main battery of the vehicle, the premises, or article, which is needed to activate and operate the vehicle, the premises, or the article, when same is desired to be used and/or in use.

[0026] In an embodiment wherein the main cutoff switch and the vehicle ignition switch are both in the “switch open” state or position or in the “OFF” state or position, which can be indicative of the vehicle not being in use, the primary vehicle battery can be completely disconnected from the vehicle ignition system and from the vehicle non-drain loads, which vehicle non-drain loads can be any electrical circuit, system, equipment system, device, or component, which requires electrical power when the vehicle, or any electrical circuit, system, equipment system, device, or component, is in use or is being operated. When the primary vehicle battery is completely disconnected from the vehicle ignition system and the vehicle non-drain loads, the electrical power and/or the charge level of the primary vehicle battery is conserved for later use. The apparatus provides the advantage

that no electrical power is drained from the primary vehicle battery **10** when the vehicle is not operating and/or not in use, thereby conserving the charge level and the electrical power of the primary vehicle battery for later use.

[0027] The apparatus can also function as a valuable vehicle anti-theft device for the vehicle as no electrical power can be provided to the vehicle ignition system when the main cutoff switch is in the “switch open” or “OFF” state or position. Even if one were to gain access to a vehicle key or otherwise attempt to bypass the vehicle ignition/On switch, the primary vehicle battery will remain disconnected from the vehicle ignition system and from the vehicle non-drain loads. In this manner, the apparatus of the present invention can also be utilized as a vehicle anti-theft system or device.

[0028] The vehicle auxiliary battery can provide electrical power to any and/or all of the drain loads which typically draw electrical power at all times and/or when the vehicle is in use, or operating, as well as when the vehicle is not in use or not operating. As noted above, the drain loads can include, for example, but are not limited to, the vehicle command computer or command computers, any computers or devices which require to be electrically powered at all times, the vehicle anti-theft system or vehicle theft-deterrent system which require to be electrically powered at all times, the remote power door locking/unlocking system and any receivers and/or computers or processing devices associated with same which require electrical power at all times, the vehicle remote starter system and any receivers and/or computers or processing devices associated with same which require electrical power at all times, the vehicle radio clock, the vehicle radio memory system, any computers or devices having or utilizing memory or any other processing capabilities which require power at all times, any gauges or associated coils which require at least some electrical power at all times to remain properly functional, and any other vehicle systems, equipment systems, components, or devices, which require electrical power at all times.

[0029] In this regard, the apparatus of the present invention can provide electrical power to the drain loads from the vehicle auxiliary battery while conserving the charge level and electrical power capacity of the primary vehicle battery. As noted above, the apparatus can also serve an anti-theft function and/or a theft-deterrence function for the vehicle as the primary vehicle battery is, and remains, completely disconnected from the vehicle ignition system when the main cutoff switch is in the “switch open” state or position or in the “OFF” state or position.

[0030] When the main cutoff switch is in the “switch closed” position, the primary vehicle battery can be capable of providing electrical power to the vehicle ignition system and to any of the vehicle non-drain loads described herein, and/or to any of the vehicle's systems, equipment systems, components, or devices, which can be powered by the primary vehicle battery upon, and/or subject to, the closing of the vehicle ignition/On switch.

[0031] When both the main cutoff switch and the vehicle ignition/On switch are in the “switch closed” or “ON” position, an operator can start the vehicle's engine by closing the vehicle ignition/On switch. Once the vehicle engine is running, the primary vehicle battery can provide electrical power to or for the vehicle ignition system as well as to or for to any of the vehicle non-drain loads described herein, and/or to any of the vehicle's systems, equipment systems, components, or devices.

[0032] During vehicle engine operation, the alternator or alternators, if more than one alternator is utilized, and/or any respective component(s) of the alternator or alternators can be driven by the vehicle engine in order to generate electrical power which can include both an alternating current (AC) power and a direct current (DC) power. If a single alternator is utilized, then the alternator can re-charge both the primary vehicle battery and the vehicle auxiliary battery during vehicle engine operation and can provide electrical power to or for any of the vehicle non-drain loads or drain loads described herein, and/or to any of the vehicle's systems, equipment systems, components, or devices. If two alternators are utilized, then one alternator can be connected to, and can re-charge, the primary vehicle battery, as well as provide AC and/or DC power to any of the vehicle non-drain loads described herein, and/or to any of the vehicle's systems, equipment

systems, components, or devices, while the other alternator can be connected to, and can re-charge, the vehicle auxiliary battery, as well as provide AC and/or DC power to any of the vehicle's drain loads. In this regard, both the primary vehicle battery and the vehicle auxiliary battery can be re-charged during vehicle engine operation.

[0033] Use of the apparatus of the present invention can be optimized if the main cutoff switch is opened, and, therefore, placed in the "switch open" state or position or in the "OFF" state or position, immediately after the vehicle engine is turned off and thereby returned to the "switch closed" state or position or the "ON" state or position just prior to attempting to start the vehicle engine or just prior to otherwise turning the vehicle, or any vehicle system, equipment system, component, or device, "ON", by closing the vehicle ignition/On switch, such as by switching the vehicle ignition/On switch to the "switch closed" state or position or to the "ON" state or position, or by otherwise simply turning and ignition key or pushing an ignition button or switch. In this regard, the primary vehicle battery can be "connected" when use of the vehicle, the vehicle engine, or any vehicle system, equipment system, component, or device powered by the primary vehicle battery, is desired, and the primary battery can be "disconnected" when use of the vehicle, the vehicle engine, or any vehicle system, equipment system, component, or device, which is powered by the primary vehicle battery, has ceased and/or is no longer desired. Substantial anti-theft advantages are also realized by the apparatus of the present invention as the vehicle engine will not be capable of being activated or started with the primary vehicle battery being disconnected from the vehicle ignition system.

[0034] The apparatus provides the vehicle auxiliary battery which can provide any and/or all of the vehicle drain loads with electrical power when the vehicle engine is off or not running, while preserving and/or conserving the battery charge level of the primary vehicle battery which can be completely disconnected from any electrical power or current drain loads, from the vehicle ignition system, and/or from any of the vehicle non-drain loads described herein, and/or from any of the vehicle's system, equipment systems, components, or devices. The apparatus provides a primary vehicle battery which can be completely disconnected from any load, from the vehicle ignition system, from any of the vehicle non-drain loads described herein, and/or to any of the vehicle's system, equipment systems, components, or devices, and/or from any of the vehicle drain loads, when the vehicle engine is not running, thereby maintaining a maximum charge level for the primary vehicle battery. Even if the charge level of the vehicle auxiliary battery should become depleted during a period of non-use of the vehicle engine, the primary vehicle battery can always have a sufficient charge level to start the vehicle engine and the respective vehicle alternator(s) can re-charge the vehicle auxiliary battery as well as can re-charge the primary vehicle battery.

[0035] In the manner described herein, the apparatus of the present invention provides a novel battery power management apparatus and method which can be utilized in order to provide an apparatus or system which can be utilized to ensure that a charge level of a primary vehicle battery can always be maintained, while allowing for sufficient electrical power to be provided to vehicle systems, equipment systems, components, or devices, which require and which continue to draw electrical power when the vehicle's engine is not running. In this regard, by using the apparatus of the present invention, one can ensure that any drain loads or short circuits will not cause a primary vehicle battery to be discharged or depleted of its charge and/or "go dead" while also ensuring that any and/or all vehicle systems, equipment systems, components, or devices, which require electrical power at all times and/or when the vehicle engine is not running, are provided with the electrical power needed to ensure their proper operation.

[0036] The can also include a voltage stabilizing load or resistor which can be utilized and which can be inserted between the circuit portion of the apparatus which is powered by the primary vehicle battery and the circuit portion of the apparatus which is powered by the vehicle auxiliary battery in order to connect the two circuit portions together. The resistor can be connected in between the positive sides of each of the primary vehicle battery and the vehicle auxiliary battery.

With the use of the resistor, electrical power can be provided from the vehicle auxiliary battery to the vehicle ignition system and to the vehicle non-drain loads, if desired, when the vehicle ignition/On switch is in the “switch closed” state or position or in the “ON” state or position, whether or not the main cutoff switch is in the “switch closed” or “ON” state or position or in the “switch open” or “OFF” state or position. When the main cutoff switch is in the “switch closed” state or position or in the “ON” state or position, electrical power can also be provided from the primary vehicle battery to the vehicle drain loads, if desired. The resistor serves to connect the two circuit portions together while providing a stabilizing voltage drop across same in the event that the respective voltages of the primary vehicle battery and the vehicle auxiliary battery are not equal.

[0037] The apparatus and method of the present invention can also be utilized in order to provide power to any vehicle systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, in the event that the vehicle engine stops running, for any reason, which can result in the loss of the power being provided to any vehicle systems, vehicle equipment systems, devices, or components, which require power for the safe operation of the vehicle and/or for operator and/or occupant safety.

[0038] The vehicle auxiliary battery can be utilized to provide electrical power to vehicle drain/non-drain loads which can include any and/or all of the vehicle drain loads as well as any loads which can be, or which can include, any of the vehicle systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, such as, but not limited to, the vehicle's power steering system, the vehicle's power brakes system, the vehicle's traction control system, the vehicle's electronic stability control system, the vehicle's anti-lock brake system, the vehicle's safety systems, the vehicle's lights, the vehicle's power door locks or vehicle power door lock systems, the vehicle's airbag systems, the vehicle's passenger restraint systems, the vehicle's supplemental restraint systems, the vehicle's communication systems, and/or the vehicle's emergency communication systems, and/or any other load, or vehicle system, equipment system, device, or component.

[0039] Any of the vehicle drain/non-drain loads can be designed to operate on DC power in the event that the vehicle engine stops running, for any reason.

[0040] The apparatus can be designed so that the vehicle auxiliary battery can provide electrical power to any and/or all of the vehicle drain/non-drain loads which are connected to same in the event the vehicle engine stops running for any reason. In this regard, the vehicle auxiliary battery can provide power to any of the vehicle systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, in the event that the vehicle engine stops running for any reason.

[0041] The primary vehicle battery can also be utilized in order to provide electrical power to the vehicle ignition system and to any number of, or any of, the vehicle non-drain loads. The primary vehicle battery can also be utilized so as to provide electrical power only to the vehicle ignition system.

[0042] The apparatus can also be utilized in such a way so that the primary vehicle battery can provide power to the vehicle non-drain loads without providing power to the vehicle ignition system. In this manner, with the vehicle ignition/On switch in the “switch open” state or position or in the “OFF” state or position, and with the main cutoff switch in the “switch closed” state or position or the “ON” state or position, the primary vehicle battery can provide power to the vehicle non-drain loads without providing power to the vehicle ignition system.

[0043] The apparatus of the present invention can be utilized in a same, a similar, and/or an analogous, manner, as described herein, in and/or with any application involving any type or kind of vehicles, premises, or articles, which utilize rechargeable batteries to provide electrical power to any type or kind of system, equipment system, component, or device, of the respective vehicle, premises, or article, while also providing electrical power to systems, equipment systems, components, or devices, of the respective vehicle, premises, or article, which require electrical power at all times.

[0044] The apparatus and methods of the present invention can also be utilized in electric vehicles, in all-electric vehicles, and in hybrid vehicles, of any and/or all types or kinds, so as to recharge the

battery, batteries, or battery pack, of the respective electric vehicle, all-electric vehicle, or hybrid vehicle, in addition to providing any and/or all of the other battery power management functions and/or functionalities described herein as being capable of being provided by apparatus and methods of the present invention. The apparatus and methods of the present invention be utilized in, or in conjunction with, any type or kind of electric, all-electric, or hybrid, vehicles, land vehicles, automobiles, buses, trains, trucks, recreational vehicles, boats, marine vessels, submarines, aircraft, airplanes, jets, helicopters, drones, spacecraft, space shuttles, recreational vehicles, motorcycles, scooters, or any other type or kind of vehicle. Any of the vehicles described herein can be manned vehicles, unmanned vehicles, and/or remote-controlled vehicles.

[0045] The apparatus and methods of the present invention can be utilized with, or in conjunction with, any rotating component, or any moving component, of any motor, motor component, electric motor, or electric motor component, transmission, transmission component, differential, differential component, axle, axle component, spindle, spindle component, reduction gear, reducer (defined herein, for purposes of this patent application, as a “type of transmission”), axle (defined herein, for purposes of this patent application, as a “vehicle electric drive or electric propulsion system or solution which includes or contains an electric motor, power electronics, and a transmission, for powering a vehicle's axle”), in-wheel motor, in-wheel motor component, and/or a wheel or wheel component, of any electric vehicle, any all-electric vehicle, or any hybrid vehicle, in order to drive a respective alternator or alternators, or in order to drive any generator or generators, so as to generate or produce electricity so as to re-charge the vehicle battery or vehicle batteries of the respective electric vehicle, all-electric vehicle, or hybrid vehicle.

[0046] The apparatus and/or the recharging mechanisms provided thereby can also be utilized along with remote control circuitry and/or remote control components which can be utilized in order to remotely open or to remotely close each of the main cutoff switch and the Power On switch, and/or to monitor or to control the battery power management functions or functionalities of the apparatus and methods of the present invention.

[0047] The apparatus of the present invention can also be utilized along with any number of alternators and/or generators in order to recharge the vehicle battery and the vehicle auxiliary battery.

[0048] The apparatus and methods of the present invention can also be utilized in, on, and/or in connection with, and/or in conjunction with, vehicles of any kinds, types, or sizes, including, but not limited to, vehicles which require, or which may require, a driver, an operator, or a pilot, self-driving vehicles, autonomous vehicles, and/or remote-controlled vehicles, any of which vehicles can also be land vehicles, air vehicles, and/or sea vehicles or marine vehicles, of any kind, type, or size, and including, but not limited to, automobiles, cars, trucks, buses, trains, subway trains, aircraft, airplanes, jets, helicopters, drones, spacecraft, and/or satellites, and/or water vehicles or marine vehicles, boats, ships, submarines, and/or submersible vehicles, or any kind, type, or size.

[0049] In this regard, in a preferred embodiment, the apparatus and methods of the present invention can be utilized in, on, and/or in connection with, and/or in conjunction with, vehicles of any kinds, types, or sizes, including, but not limited to, vehicles which require, or which may require, a driver, an operator, or a pilot, self-driving vehicles, autonomous vehicles, and/or remote-controlled vehicles. Further, the apparatus and methods of the present invention can also be utilized in, on, and/or in connection with, and/or in conjunction with, land vehicles, air vehicles, and/or sea vehicles or marine vehicles, of any kind, type, or size. Still further, the apparatus and methods of the present invention can also be utilized in, on, and/or in connection with, and/or in conjunction with, automobiles, cars, trucks, buses, trains, subway trains, aircraft, airplanes, jets, helicopters, drones, spacecraft, and/or satellites, and/or water vehicles or marine vehicles, boats, ships, submarines, and/or submersible vehicles, or any kind, type, or size.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0050] In the Drawings:

[0051] FIG. 1 illustrates a schematic diagram of a preferred embodiment of the apparatus of the present invention;

[0052] FIG. 2 illustrates another preferred embodiment of the apparatus of FIG. 1;

[0053] FIG. 3 illustrates the apparatus of FIG. 1 showing the main cutoff switch and the vehicle ignition switch both in the “switch open” state or position or in the “OFF” state or position;

[0054] FIG. 4 illustrates the apparatus of FIG. 1 showing the main cutoff switch in the “switch closed” state or position or the “ON” state or position and showing the vehicle ignition/On switch in the “switch open” state or position or in the “OFF” state or position;

[0055] FIG. 5 illustrates the apparatus of FIG. 1 showing both the main cutoff switch and the vehicle ignition/On switch in the “switch closed” state or position or in the “ON” state or position;

[0056] FIG. 6 illustrates another preferred embodiment of the apparatus of FIG. 1;

[0057] FIG. 7 illustrates still another preferred embodiment of the apparatus of FIG. 1;

[0058] FIG. 8 illustrates yet another preferred embodiment of the apparatus of FIG. 1;

[0059] FIGS. 9A, 9B, and 9C illustrate another preferred embodiment of the apparatus of the present invention;

[0060] FIGS. 10A and 10B illustrate preferred embodiment mechanism for recharging the vehicle battery and the vehicle auxiliary battery of an electric vehicle, an all-electric vehicle, and/or a hybrid vehicle;

[0061] FIG. 11 illustrates another preferred embodiment of the apparatus of the present invention;

[0062] FIG. 12 illustrates still another preferred embodiment of the apparatus of the present invention; and

[0063] FIG. 13 illustrates yet another preferred embodiment of the apparatus of the present invention.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

[0064] The present invention pertains to a battery power management apparatus and method and, in particular, to a battery power management apparatus and method which can conserve battery power and/or battery charge level for electrical systems and/or components which do not require power when a vehicle, a premises, or an article, is not operating or not in use, while providing power to and/or for electrical systems and/or components which require power when the vehicle, the premises, or the article, is not operating or not in use, or which otherwise needs to be provided with power when a power source and/or a recharging source ceases to operate, is non-operational, or is turned off, and/or the present invention pertains to a battery power management apparatus and method which can be utilized to generate electric power so as to recharge a battery or batteries of an electric vehicle or a hybrid vehicle, of any type or kind, while the electric vehicle or the hybrid is in use or operating, as well as which can be utilized to conserve battery power and/or battery charge level for an electric vehicle or a hybrid vehicle, of any type or kind, as well as for any electrical systems and/or components of the same, which do not require power when the electric vehicle or the hybrid vehicle is not operating or not in use, while providing power to and/or for electrical systems and/or components which require power when the electric vehicle or the hybrid vehicle is not operating or not in use, or which otherwise need to be provided with power when a power source and/or a battery recharging source ceases to operate or is not operational.

[0065] The apparatus and method of the present invention can be utilized in any number of a wide variety of applications, including but not limited to, applications in, or in connection with, motor vehicles, automobiles, trucks, mass transportation vehicles, buses, school buses, trains, subway trains, aircraft, airplanes, jets, gliders, hot air balloons, spacecraft, space shuttles, satellites, boats,

marine vehicles, marine vessels, submarines, motorcycles, motor scooters, recreational vehicles (RVs) of any type or kind, mobile homes, jet skis, equipment of any kind or type, or any other vehicle (hereinafter referred to as a “vehicle” or “vehicles”), or in applications in, or in connection with, premises, residential premises, commercial premises, buildings, structures, land, or any land and/or structure of any type or kind (hereinafter referred to as a “premises” or “premises”), or in applications in, with, or in connection with, any article or device (hereinafter “article” or “articles”) which utilizes a battery or a DC power source and which is also equipped for, adapted for, or capable of, recharging that battery or DC power source. The apparatus and method of the present invention can be utilized in connection with gasoline-powered vehicles, diesel-powered vehicles, or any other fuel-powered vehicles, combustion engine powered vehicles, electric-powered vehicles, hybrid-powered vehicles, or any other types or kinds of vehicles.

[0066] The apparatus and method of the present invention can also provide a apparatus and method for remotely controlling, monitoring, and/or securing the battery power management apparatus of the present invention.

[0067] Applicant hereby incorporates by reference herein the subject matter and teachings of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/232,578, filed Aug. 10, 2023, and entitled “BATTERY POWER MANAGEMENT APPARATUS AND METHOD”, the subject matter and teachings of which are hereby incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

[0068] Applicant hereby incorporates by reference herein the subject matter and teachings of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/544,983, filed Dec. 8, 2021, and entitled “BATTERY POWER MANAGEMENT APPARATUS AND METHOD”, the subject matter and teachings of which are hereby incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

[0069] Applicant hereby incorporates by reference herein the subject matter and teachings of U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 63/149,530, filed Feb. 15, 2021, and entitled “BATTERY POWER MANAGEMENT APPARATUS AND METHOD”, the subject matter and teachings of which are hereby incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

[0070] Applicant hereby incorporates by reference herein the subject matter and teachings of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/705,996, filed May 7, 2015, and entitled “BATTERY POWER MANAGEMENT APPARATUS AND METHOD”, the subject matter and teachings of which are hereby incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

[0071] Applicant hereby incorporates by reference herein the subject matter and teachings of U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 62/025,445, filed Jul. 16, 2014, and entitled “BATTERY POWER MANAGEMENT APPARATUS AND METHOD”, the subject matter and teachings of which are hereby incorporated by reference herein in their entirety. Applicant also hereby incorporates by reference herein the subject matter and teachings of U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 62/018,687, filed Jun. 30, 2014, and entitled “BATTERY POWER MANAGEMENT APPARATUS AND METHOD”, the subject matter and teachings of which are hereby incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

[0072] FIG. 1 illustrates a schematic diagram of a preferred embodiment of the apparatus of the present invention which is designated generally by the reference numeral **100**. In a preferred embodiment, the apparatus **100** is illustrated and described as being utilized in, on, or in connection with, a motor vehicle such as, but not limited to, a car, an automobile, or a truck. Although the apparatus **100** of FIG. 1 is illustrated and described as being utilized in, on, or in connection with, a motor vehicle, it is to be understood that the apparatus **100** of the present invention can also be utilized in, on, or in connection with, or can be adapted for and utilized in, on, or in connection with, any of the herein-identified and/or herein-defined vehicles, premises, or articles.

[0073] With reference to FIG. 1, the apparatus **100**, in a preferred embodiment, includes a primary vehicle battery **10** which can be connected to or with, or which is connectable to and/or with, the vehicle ignition system as well as any other vehicle electrical system or device or vehicle electronic system or device of the vehicle and which does not draw electrical power or current when the

vehicle or the vehicle ignition system is not in use (hereafter collectively referred to as “non-drain loads **30**”). In a preferred embodiment, the primary vehicle battery **10** can be any battery or DC power source which is suitable for use in, on, or in connection with, the particular vehicle. For example, if the vehicle is an automobile, the primary vehicle battery **10** can be any **12** Volt battery typically utilized as an automobile battery.

[0074] With reference once again to FIG. **1**, the primary vehicle battery **10** can be electrically connected with, or coupled to, the vehicle ignition system **20** in any appropriate circuit configuration, such as, but not limited to, a parallel connection or a series connection, or any combination of same, and to any number of any of the other non-drain loads in, on, or of, the vehicle, which are collectively designated by the reference numeral **30** in any appropriate circuit configuration, such as, but not limited to, a parallel connection or a series connection. The vehicle non-drain loads **30** can be any electrical circuit, system, equipment system, device, or component, which requires electrical power when the vehicle, or any electrical circuit, system, equipment system, device, or component, is in use or is being operated.

[0075] In a preferred embodiment, the apparatus **100** and the circuitry of the vehicle can be designed and implemented so that the vehicle ignition system **20** and all of the vehicle non-drain loads **30**, and any associated or corresponding vehicle systems, equipment systems, components, and devices, are to be provided with electrical power from the primary vehicle battery **10**.

[0076] With reference once again to FIG. **1**, the apparatus **100** also includes a main cutoff switch **40** which is connected in series with the primary vehicle battery, as shown. In a preferred embodiment, the main cutoff switch **40** serves to disconnect the primary vehicle battery **10** from all vehicle circuits and/or devices including, but not limited to, the vehicle ignition system **20** and the vehicle non-drain loads **30**. In this regard, the cutoff switch **40** can be utilized to completely and electrically disconnect the primary vehicle battery **10** from any and all loads in, on, or connected with, the vehicle.

[0077] In a preferred embodiment, the main cutoff switch **40** can be a manual switch which can be placed at any suitable or convenient location in or on the vehicle and/or the main cutoff switch **40** can also be a remotely controlled switch, such as those typically utilized in connection with remote controlled vehicle starters or remote controlled vehicle ignition systems. In this regard, in a preferred embodiment, a remote control device can be utilized to transmit, via a transmitter, a radio frequency (RF) signal, an infrared (IR) signal, or any other suitable signal, or communication transmission, which can be received by a corresponding receiver in, on, or at the vehicle, which can be processed by a receiver or any other appropriate controller, control device, computer, or other device, which can cause the main cutoff switch **40** to close in order to remotely enable the vehicle to be utilized, or the can cause the main cutoff switch to open so as to disable vehicle operation. In FIG. **1**, the main cutoff switch **40** is shown in the “switch open” or “OFF” state or position.

[0078] With reference once again to FIG. **1**, the apparatus **100** also includes a vehicle ignition/On switch **50**, which is connected in series with the primary vehicle battery **10**, as shown, and which can be utilized to electrically connect or electrically disconnect the primary vehicle battery **10** to or from each of to the vehicle ignition system **20** and/or to or from each of any number of the non-drain loads **30**. The vehicle ignition/On switch **50** can also be utilized to selectively activate the vehicle ignition system **20** in order to start the vehicle engine and/or to activate, and/or to enable an activation of, any one or more of any of the vehicles systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, and/or any vehicle non-drain loads **30**, of the vehicle and/or to activate, and/or to enable the activation of, any one or more of the electrical circuits, systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, and/or any vehicle non-drain loads **30**, of the vehicle which require electrical power for use or operation.

[0079] In a preferred embodiment, the vehicle ignition/On switch **50** can be a manual switch, such as those which are typically utilized in connection with a vehicle key and/or the vehicle ignition/On switch **50** can also be a remotely controlled switch, such as those typically utilized in connection

with remote controlled vehicle starters or remote controlled vehicle ignition systems. In this regard in a preferred embodiment, a remote control device can be utilized to transmit, via a transmitter, a radio frequency (RF) signal, an infrared (IR) signal, or any other suitable signal, or communication transmission, which can be received by a corresponding receiver in, on, or at the vehicle, which can be processed by the receiver or any other appropriate controller, control device, computer, or other device, which can cause the vehicle ignition/On switch **50** to close in order to remotely start the vehicle's engine or can, in and under appropriate and safe circumstances, such when the vehicle engine is off, cause the vehicle ignition/On switch **50** to open so as to disable vehicle operation or vehicle engine operation. In FIG. **1**, the vehicle ignition/On switch **50** is shown in the "switch open" or "OFF" state or position.

[0080] With reference once again to FIG. **1**, the apparatus **100**, in a preferred embodiment, also includes, a vehicle auxiliary battery **60**, as shown. In a preferred embodiment, the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** can be the same as, or can be of the same type or kind of battery or DC power source as the primary vehicle battery **10**. In a preferred embodiment, both of the primary vehicle battery **10** and the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** can be 12 volt automobile batteries, in the case where the vehicle is an automobile, which can have similar, if not identical, specifications and which can be recharged from, by, with, or using, the same electrical vehicle alternator described herein. The vehicle auxiliary battery **60** is connected in series or in parallel with each of all of the vehicle devices, equipment, equipment systems, or components, which typically drain current from a vehicle battery when the vehicle or the vehicle ignition system is not in operation or "off" (hereinafter collectively referred to as the "drain loads **70**").

[0081] In a preferred embodiment, the drain loads **70** can include, for example, but are not limited to, the vehicle command computer or command computers, any computers or devices which require to be electrically powered at all times, the vehicle anti-theft system or vehicle theft-deterrent system which require to be electrically powered at all times, the remote power door locking/unlocking system and any receivers and/or computers or processing devices associated with same which require electrical power at all times, the vehicle remote starter system and any receivers and/or computers or processing devices associated with same which require electrical power at all times, the vehicle radio clock, the vehicle radio memory system, any computers or devices having or utilizing memory or any other processing capabilities which require power at all times, any gauges or associated coils which require at least some electrical power at all times to remain properly functional, and any other vehicle systems, equipment systems, components, or devices, which require electrical power at all times. In this regard, the drain loads **70** can include, but are not limited to, a vehicle anti-theft system, a vehicle radio memory storage system or device, a radio clock, any command computer or command computers, remote door opening systems, or devices, remote control systems or devices, or any other systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, which are known to drain electrical power at all times and which can drain a vehicle battery of current and deplete its charge or charge level when a vehicle is typically not in use or is not operating.

[0082] In a preferred embodiment, the apparatus **100** and the circuitry of the vehicle can be designed and implemented so that the vehicle drain loads **70** and any associated or corresponding vehicle systems, equipment systems, components, and devices, are to be provided with electrical power from the vehicle auxiliary battery **60**.

[0083] With reference once again to FIG. **1**, the apparatus **100** can also be connected to or with the vehicle alternator **80**, which alternator is typically equipped to, and also used in order to, perform a number of functions including, but not limited to, recharging the battery of a vehicle, and which can be utilized in the apparatus **100** of the present invention in order to continuously re-charge each of the primary vehicle battery **10** and the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** of the apparatus **100** of the present invention. In a preferred embodiment, a single vehicle alternator **80** can be used to recharge both the primary vehicle battery **10** and the vehicle auxiliary battery **60**. In another preferred

embodiment, two alternators can also be utilized so that one alternator **80** can be utilized to charge the primary vehicle battery **10** and so that the other alternator **80** can be utilized to charge the vehicle auxiliary battery **60**. In a preferred embodiment, any pertinent circuits, components, or devices, of the alternator **80** can be connected between each respective electrical circuit or connector(s) associated with the recharging of each of the primary vehicle battery **10** and the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** and a vehicle ground **90** as needed or desired. In a preferred embodiment, the apparatus **100** can also be connected to the vehicle ground **90** as needed or desired.

[0084] In a preferred embodiment in which two alternators **80** are employed, one of the alternators can be dedicated for performing all of the functions of a typical vehicle alternator as well as, and including, recharging the primary vehicle battery **10** and providing electrical power to the vehicle ignition system **20**, the vehicle non-drain loads **30**, or any electrical circuit, system, equipment system, device, or component, of the vehicle which requires electrical power when the vehicle, or any electrical circuit, system, equipment system, device, or component, is in use or is being operated, while the second alternator can be dedicated for recharging the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** and, if needed or desired, for performing any other functions such as providing electrical power to any of the drain loads **70** of the vehicle. In an embodiment in which two alternators **80** are utilized, the first alternator **80** can be connected to vehicle ground **90** and to each of the various vehicle electrical circuits needed for providing any needed electrical power to the various electrical circuits, systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, of, in, on, or associated with, the vehicle and for recharging the primary vehicle battery **10**, while the second alternator **80** can be connected to vehicle ground **90** and to any vehicle electrical circuit(s) needed for recharging the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** as well as to any other electrical circuit(s) for which the second alternator **80** is being utilized to supply electrical power.

[0085] FIG. **2** illustrates another preferred embodiment of the apparatus **100** of FIG. **1**. With reference to FIG. **2**, the apparatus **100** includes all of the components of the apparatus **100** of FIG. **1** along with the addition of remote control circuitry and/or remote control components which can be utilized in order to remotely open or to remotely close each of the main cutoff switch **40** and the vehicle ignition/On switch **50**.

[0086] With reference to FIG. **2**, the apparatus **100** can include a transmitter **42**, which can be any type or kind of remote control transmitter for opening or closing the circuit controlled by the main cutoff switch **40** and which, in a preferred embodiment, can be integrated into and/or with a vehicle remote control device, a key chain, or a key fob, or any other device, a receiver **44** located at, in, or on, the vehicle, for receiving a signal, signals, or sequence of signals, transmitted from the transmitter **42** and indicative of a main shutoff switch opening operation or a main cutoff switch closing operation, a controller **46** for processing any signal, signals, or sequence of signals, received by the receiver **44**, and an electronically activated switching device **48** which can be located in parallel with the main cutoff switch **40**, which can serve to close or open the circuit controlled by the main cutoff switch **40**. In a preferred embodiment, the electronically activated switching device **48** can be placed in parallel with the main cutoff switch **40** so that it can simply bypass the main cutoff switch **40** in a preferred embodiment.

[0087] With reference once again to FIG. **2**, the apparatus **100** can include a transmitter **52**, which can be any type or kind of remote control transmitter for opening or closing the circuit controlled by the vehicle ignition/On switch **50** and which, in a preferred embodiment, can also be integrated into and/or with a vehicle remote control device, a key chain, or a key fob, or any other device, a receiver **54** located at, in, or on, the vehicle, for receiving a signal, signals, or sequence of signals, transmitted from the transmitter **52** and indicative of a vehicle ignition switch opening operation or a vehicle ignition switch closing operation, a controller **56** for processing any signal, signals, or sequence of signals, received by the receiver **54**, and an electronically activated switching device **58** which can be located in parallel with the vehicle ignition/On switch **50**, which can serve to close or

open the circuit controlled by the vehicle ignition/On switch **50**. In a preferred embodiment, the electronically activated switching device **58** can be placed in parallel with the vehicle ignition/On switch **50** so that it can simply bypass the vehicle ignition/On switch **50** in a preferred embodiment. [0088] In a preferred embodiment, the transmitter **42** and/or the transmitter **52** can also be implemented by, replaced by, or used in conjunction with, a central processing computer or an Internet server **200** (hereinafter “central processing computer **200**”), which can be associated with a web site. In another preferred embodiment, any authorized user or authorized person can utilize any suitable communication device **250**, which, in a preferred embodiment, can be a personal computer, a tablet, a tablet computer, a laptop computer, a notebook computer, a cellular telephone, a wireless telephone, a personal digital assistant, or any other suitable device, in order to transmit any respective signal, signals, or sequence of signals, to the respective receiver **44** and/or to the respective receiver **54** via the central processing computer **200** on, over, or via, the Internet and/or the World Wide Web, and/or on or over any other communication network(s), wireless communication network(s), or any combination of same. In this regard, in a preferred embodiment, any authorized user or authorized person can use or control the apparatus **100** of the present invention on, over, or via, the Internet and/or the World Wide Web and/or any other communication network(s), wireless communication network(s), or any combination of same.

[0089] The apparatus **100** of the present invention can be utilized in order to provide and to perform battery power management in and for any of the herein-described vehicles, premises, or articles, by providing, and/or by allowing for, the electrical powering of any electrical devices which typically require electrical power at all times and/or when the respective vehicle, premises, or article, is not operating and/or not in use, while, at the same time, conserving the power of the main battery of the vehicle, the premises, or the article, which is needed to activate and operate the vehicle, the premises, or the article, when same is desired to be used and/or in use. In a preferred embodiment, the use and operation of the apparatus **100** of the present invention can be described and illustrated in connection with use in a vehicle, such as an automobile. Although described and illustrated as being used and operated in connection with an automobile, it is important to note that the apparatus **100** can be utilized in, with, or in conjunction with, any vehicle, premises, or article.

[0090] FIG. **3** illustrates the apparatus **100** of FIG. **1** showing the main cutoff switch **40** and the vehicle ignition switch **50** both in the “switch open” state or position or in the “OFF” state or position. In the embodiment of FIG. **3**, which is indicative of the vehicle not being in use, the primary vehicle battery is completely disconnected from the vehicle ignition system **20** and the vehicle non-drain loads **30**, which vehicle non-drain loads **30** can be any electrical circuit, system, equipment system, device, or component, which requires electrical power when the vehicle, or any electrical circuit, system, equipment system, device, or component, is in use or is being operated. When the primary vehicle battery **10** is completely disconnected from the vehicle ignition system **20** and the vehicle non-drain loads **30**, as shown in FIG. **3**, the electrical power and/or the charge level of the primary vehicle battery **10** is conserved for later use. The apparatus **100**, when utilized as shown in FIG. **3**, provides the advantage that no electrical power is drained from the primary vehicle battery **10** when the vehicle is not operating or not in use, thereby conserving the charge level and the electrical power of the primary vehicle battery **10** for later use.

[0091] The apparatus **100**, when utilized as shown in FIG. **3**, can also function as a vehicle anti-theft device for the vehicle as no electrical power can be provided to the vehicle ignition system **20** when the main cutoff switch is in the “switch open” or “OFF” state or position. Even if one were to gain access to a vehicle key or otherwise attempt to bypass the vehicle ignition/On switch **50**, the primary vehicle battery **10** will remain disconnected from the vehicle ignition system **20** and from the vehicle non-drain loads **30** when the main cutoff switch is in the “switch open” or “OFF” state or position. In this manner, the apparatus **100** of the present invention can also be utilized as a vehicle anti-theft system or device.

[0092] With reference once again to FIG. **3**, the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** provides electrical

power to any and/or all of the drain loads **70** which typically draw electrical power at all times and/or when the vehicle is in use, or operating, as well as when the vehicle is not in use or not operating. As noted above, the drain loads **70** can include, for example, but are not limited to, the vehicle command computer or command computers, any computers or devices which require to be electrically powered at all times, the vehicle anti-theft system or vehicle theft-deterrent system which require to be electrically powered at all times, the remote power door locking/unlocking system and any receivers and/or computers or processing devices associated with same which require electrical power at all times, the vehicle remote starter system and any receivers and/or computers or processing devices associated with same which require electrical power at all times, the vehicle radio clock, the vehicle radio memory system, any computers or devices having or utilizing memory or any other processing capabilities which require power at all times, any gauges or associated coils which require at least some electrical power at all times to remain properly functional, and any other vehicle systems, equipment systems, components, or devices, which require electrical power at all times.

[0093] In this regard, when used as shown in FIG. **3**, the apparatus **100** can serve to provide electrical power to the drain loads **70** from the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** while conserving the charge level and electrical power capacity of the primary vehicle battery **10**. As noted above, the apparatus **100** of FIG. **3** also serves an anti-theft function and/or a theft-deterrence function for the vehicle as the primary vehicle battery **10** is, and remains, completely disconnected from the vehicle ignition system **20** in the embodiment of FIG. **3** when the main cutoff switch is in the “switch open” state or position or in the “OFF” state or position.

[0094] The embodiment of FIG. **3** also illustrates an exemplary embodiment wherein the apparatus **100** can be utilized to provide security against a theft or an unauthorized use of the vehicle simply by the main cutoff switch **40** being maintained in the “switch open” or “OFF” state or position.

[0095] FIG. **4** illustrates the apparatus **100** of FIG. **1** showing the main cutoff switch **40** in the “switch closed” state or position or the “ON” state or position and showing the vehicle ignition/On switch **50** in the “switch open” state or position or in the “OFF” state or position. When the main cutoff switch **40** is in the “switch closed” state or position or the “ON” state or position, the primary vehicle battery **10** is capable of providing electrical power to the vehicle ignition system **20** and to any of the vehicle non-drain loads **30** described herein, and/or to any of the vehicle's systems, equipment systems, components, or devices, which can be powered by the primary vehicle battery **10**, upon, and/or subject to, the closing of the vehicle ignition/On switch **50**.

[0096] FIG. **5** illustrates the apparatus **100** of FIG. **1** showing both the main cutoff switch **40** and the vehicle ignition/On switch **50** in the “switch closed” state or position or in the “ON” state or position. With reference to FIG. **5**, with the main cutoff switch **40** being closed or in the “ON” position, an operator can start the vehicle's engine by closing the vehicle ignition/On switch **50**. Once the vehicle engine is running, the primary vehicle battery **10** can provide electrical power to or for the vehicle ignition system **20** as well as to or for to any of the vehicle non-drain loads **30** described herein, and/or to any of the vehicle's systems, equipment systems, components, or devices.

[0097] During vehicle engine operation, the alternator **80** or alternators **80**, if more than one alternator is utilized, and/or any respective component(s) of the alternator **80** or alternators **80**, will be driven by the vehicle engine in order to generate electrical power which can include both an alternating current (AC) power and a direct current (DC) power. If a single alternator **80** is utilized, then the alternator **80** will re-charge both the primary vehicle battery **10** and the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** during vehicle engine operation and will also provide electrical power to or for any of the vehicle non-drain loads **30** or drain loads **70** described herein, and/or to any of the vehicle's systems, equipment systems, components, or devices. If two alternators are utilized, then one alternator **80** can be connected to, and can re-charge, the primary vehicle battery **10**, and can provide AC and/or DC power to any of the vehicle non-drain loads **30** described herein, and/or to

any of the vehicle's systems, equipment systems, components, or devices, while the other alternator **80** can be connected to, and can re-charge, the vehicle auxiliary battery **60**, and can provide AC and/or DC power to any of the vehicle's drain loads **70**. In this regard, both the primary vehicle battery **10** and the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** can be re-charged during vehicle engine operation. [0098] In a preferred embodiment, the apparatus **100** provides the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** which can provide any and/or all of the vehicle drain loads **70** with electrical power when the vehicle engine is off or not running, while preserving and/or conserving the battery charge level of the primary vehicle battery **10** which can be completely disconnected from any electrical power or current drain loads, from the vehicle ignition system, and/or from any of the vehicle non-drain loads **30** described herein, and/or from any of the vehicle's system, equipment systems, components, or devices. The apparatus **100** provides a primary vehicle battery **10** which can be completely disconnected from any load, from the vehicle ignition system **20**, from any of the vehicle non-drain loads **30** described herein, and/or to any of the vehicle's system, equipment systems, components, or devices, and/or from any of the vehicle drain loads **70**, when the vehicle engine is not running, thereby maintaining a maximum charge level for the primary vehicle battery **10**. Even if the charge level of the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** should become depleted during a period of non-use of the vehicle engine, the primary vehicle battery **10** can always have a sufficient charge level to start the vehicle engine and the respective vehicle alternator(s) **80** can re-charge the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** as well as can re-charge the primary vehicle battery **10**.

[0099] Use of the apparatus **100** of the present invention can be optimized if the main cutoff switch **40** is opened, and, therefore, placed in the "switch open" state or position or in the "OFF" state or position, immediately after the vehicle engine is turned off and thereby returned to the "switch closed" state or position or the "ON" state or position just prior to attempting to start the vehicle engine or just prior to otherwise turning the vehicle, or any vehicle system, equipment system, component, or device, "ON", by closing the vehicle ignition/On switch **50**, such as by switching the vehicle ignition/On switch **50** to the "switch closed" state or position or to the "ON" state or position, or by otherwise simply turning and ignition key or pushing an ignition button or switch. In this regard, the primary vehicle battery **10** can be "connected" when use of the vehicle, the vehicle engine, or any vehicle system, equipment system, component, or device powered by the primary vehicle battery, is desired, and the primary battery **10** can be "disconnected" when use of the vehicle, the vehicle engine, or any vehicle system, equipment system, component, or device, which is powered by the primary vehicle battery **10**, has ceased and/or is no longer desired. Substantial anti-theft advantages are also realized by the apparatus **100** of the present invention as the vehicle engine will not be capable of being activated or started with the primary vehicle battery **10** being disconnected from the vehicle ignition system **20**.

[0100] In the manner described herein, the apparatus **100** of the present invention provides a novel battery power management apparatus and method which can be utilized in order to provide an apparatus **100** or system which can be utilized to ensure that a charge level of a primary vehicle battery **10** can always be maintained, while allowing for sufficient electrical power to be provided to vehicle systems, equipment systems, components, or devices, which require and which continue to draw electrical power when the vehicle's engine is not running. In this regard, by using the apparatus **100** of the present invention, one can ensure that drain loads **70** or short circuits will not cause a primary vehicle battery **10** to discharge or to be depleted of its charge and/or "go dead" while also ensuring that any and/or all vehicle systems, equipment systems, components, or devices, which require electrical power at all times and/or when the vehicle engine is not running are provided with the electrical power needed to ensure their proper operation.

[0101] In another preferred embodiment, the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** can be utilized to provide electrical power to the circuit portion of the apparatus **100** which is connected to the primary vehicle battery **10** while the primary vehicle battery **10** can be utilized to provide electrical power to the circuit portion of the apparatus **100** which is connected to the vehicle auxiliary battery **60**.

FIG. 6 illustrates another preferred embodiment of the apparatus **100** of FIG. 1. In the embodiment of FIG. 6, the apparatus **100** can also include a voltage stabilizing load or resistor **95** (hereinafter “resistor **95**” or “load **95**”) which can be utilized and which can be inserted between the circuit portion of the apparatus **100** which is powered by the primary vehicle battery **10** and the circuit portion of the apparatus **100** which is powered by the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** in order to connect the two circuit portions together. The resistor **95** can be connected in between the positive sides of each of the primary vehicle battery **10** and the vehicle auxiliary battery **60**, as shown in FIG. 6.

[0102] With the use of the resistor **95**, electrical power can be provided from the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** to the vehicle ignition system **20** and to the vehicle non-drain loads **30**, if desired, when the vehicle ignition/On switch **50** is in the “switch closed” state or position or in the “ON” state or position, whether or not the main cutoff switch **40** is in the “switch closed” or “ON” state or position or in the “switch open” or “OFF” state or position. When the main cutoff switch **40** is in the “switch closed” state or position or in the “ON” state or position, electrical power can also be provided from the primary vehicle battery **10** to the vehicle drain loads **70**, if desired. The resistor **95** serves to connect the two circuit portions together while providing a stabilizing voltage drop across same in the event that the respective voltages of the primary vehicle battery **10** and the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** are not equal.

[0103] In another preferred embodiment, the apparatus **100** and method of the present invention can also be utilized in order to provide power to any vehicle systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, in the event that the vehicle engine stops running, for any reason, which can result in the loss of the power being provided to any vehicle systems, vehicle equipment systems, devices, or components, which require power for the safe operation of the vehicle and/or for operator and/or occupant safety.

[0104] FIG. 7 illustrates another preferred embodiment of the apparatus **100** of FIG. 1. In FIG. 7, the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** provides electrical power to the vehicle drain/non-drain loads **75**. In a preferred embodiment, the vehicle drain/non-drain loads **75** include any and/or all of the vehicle drain loads **70** as well as any loads which can be, or which can include any of the vehicle systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, such as, but not limited to, the vehicle's power steering system, the vehicle's power brakes system, the vehicle's traction control system, the vehicle's electronic stability control system, the vehicle's anti-lock brake system, the vehicle's safety systems, the vehicle's lights, the vehicle's power door locks or vehicle power door lock systems, the vehicle's airbag systems, the vehicle's passenger restraint systems, the vehicle's supplemental restraint systems, the vehicle's communication systems, and/or the vehicle's emergency communication systems, and/or any other load, or vehicle system, equipment system, device, or component. In a preferred embodiment, any of the vehicle drain/non-drain loads **75** can be designed to operate on DC power in the event that the vehicle engine stops running, for any reason.

[0105] With reference to FIG. 7, the apparatus **100** is designed so that the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** can provide electrical power to any and/or all of the vehicle drain/non-drain loads **75** which are connected to same in the event the vehicle engine stops running for any reason. In this regard, the vehicle auxiliary battery **60** can provide power to any of the loads, vehicle systems, equipment systems, devices, or components, in the event that the vehicle engine stops running for any reason.

[0106] In another preferred embodiment, the primary vehicle battery **10** can be utilized in order to provide electrical power to the vehicle ignition system **20** and to any number of, or any of, the vehicle non-drain loads **30**. In yet another preferred embodiment, the primary vehicle battery **10** can also be utilized so as to provide electrical power only to the vehicle ignition system **20**.

[0107] In another preferred embodiment, the apparatus **100** can also be utilized in such a way so that the primary vehicle battery **10** can provide power to the vehicle non-drain loads **30** without providing power to the vehicle ignition system **20**. FIG. 8 illustrates another preferred embodiment

of the apparatus **100** of FIG. **1**. With reference to FIG. **8**, the vehicle ignition/On switch **50** is situated at the location shown. In this manner, with the vehicle ignition/On switch **50** in the “switch open” state or position or in the “OFF” state or position, and with the main cutoff switch in the “switch closed” state or position or in the “ON” state or position, the primary vehicle battery **10** can provide power to the vehicle non-drain loads **30** without providing power to the vehicle ignition system **20**.

[0108] The apparatus **100** of the present invention can be utilized in a same, a similar, and/or an analogous, manner, as described herein, in and/or with any application involving any type or kind of vehicles, premises, or articles, which utilize rechargeable batteries to provide electrical power to any type or kind of system, equipment system, component, or device, of the respective vehicle, premises, or article, while also providing electrical power to systems, equipment systems, components, or devices, of the respective vehicle, premises, or article, which require electrical power at all times.

[0109] In another preferred embodiment, as well as in any and/or all of the other embodiments described herein, the apparatus and methods of the present invention can also be utilized in electric vehicles, in all-electric vehicles, and in hybrid vehicles, of any and/or all types or kinds, so as to recharge the battery, batteries, or battery pack, of the respective electric vehicle, all-electric vehicle, or hybrid vehicle, in addition to providing any and/or all of the other battery power management functions and/or functionalities described herein as being capable of being provided by apparatus and methods of the present invention. In a preferred embodiment, the apparatus and methods of the present invention be utilized in, or in conjunction with, any type or kind of electric, all-electric, or hybrid, vehicles, land vehicles, automobiles, buses, trains, trucks, recreational vehicles, boats, marine vessels, submarines, aircraft, airplanes, jets, helicopters, drones, spacecraft, space shuttles, recreational vehicles, motorcycles, scooters, or any other type or kind of vehicle. In a preferred embodiment, any of the vehicles described herein can be manned vehicles, unmanned vehicles, and/or remote-controlled vehicles.

[0110] In a preferred embodiment, the apparatus and methods of the present invention can be utilized with, or in conjunction with, any rotating component, or any moving component, of any motor, motor component, electric motor, or electric motor component, transmission, transmission component, differential, differential component, axle, axle component, spindle, spindle component, reduction gear, reducer (defined herein, for purposes of this patent application, as a “type of transmission”), e axle (defined herein, for purposes of this patent application, as a “vehicle electric drive or electric propulsion system or solution which includes or contains an electric motor, power electronics, and a transmission, for powering a vehicle's axle”), in-wheel motor, in-wheel motor component, and/or a wheel or wheel component, of any electric vehicle, any all-electric vehicle, or any hybrid vehicle, in order to drive a respective alternator or alternators, or in order to drive any generator or generators, so as to generate or produce electricity so as to re-charge the vehicle battery or vehicle batteries of the respective electric vehicle, all-electric vehicle, or hybrid vehicle.

[0111] FIGS. **9A**, **9B**, and **9C** illustrate another preferred embodiment of the present invention which can be utilized in, on, with, or in conjunction with, an electric vehicle, an all-electric vehicle, or a hybrid vehicle, so as to recharge the battery or batteries of the same and/or as well as to provide any of the herein-described battery power management functions or functionalities described herein. The apparatus of FIGS. **9A**, **9B**, and **9C** is designated by the reference number **300**. In a preferred embodiment of FIGS. **9A**, **9B**, and **9C**, the apparatus can be utilized in, on, with, or in conjunction with, any electric vehicle, all-electric vehicle, or hybrid vehicle, of any type or kind, described herein and/or otherwise. With reference to FIG. **9A**, **9B**, and **9C**, the apparatus **300** includes and electric vehicle motor or propulsion system or hybrid vehicle motor or propulsion system **120** (hereinafter referred to as “electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120**”).

[0112] In a preferred embodiment, the apparatus **300** of FIGS. **9A**, **9B**, and **9C**, with the exception of the vehicle ignition system **20** of the apparatus **100** of FIG. **7**, which is replaced with the electric

vehicle motor/propulsion system **120**, includes all of the components of the apparatus **100** of FIG. **1**. In this regard, the apparatus **300** of FIGS. **9A**, **9B**, and **9C** includes vehicle battery **10**, switch **40**, Power On switch **51** (which Power On switch **51** serves an electric vehicle, all-electric vehicle, or hybrid vehicle, equivalent of, or counterpart to, a vehicle ignition/On switch **50**), vehicle auxiliary battery **60**, vehicle non-drain loads **30**, vehicle drain/non-drain loads **75**, alternator(s) **80**, vehicle ground **90**, and electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120**, connected and/or configured as show in each of FIGS. **9A**, **9B**, and **9C**.

[0113] In a preferred embodiment, the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120** can include a vehicle electric motor or any number of vehicle electric motors, which can be used to propel or power vehicle movement or propulsion, and/or can include any combination of a vehicle electric motor or vehicle electric motors, or an in-wheel motor or in-wheel motors, and/or a transmission, a differential, an axle, a spindle, a reduction gear, a reducer (defined herein, for purposes of this patent application, as a “type of transmission”), an eaxle (defined herein, for purposes of this patent application, as a “vehicle electric drive or electric propulsion system or solution which includes or contains an electric motor, power electronics, and a transmission, for powering a vehicle's axle”), and/or a wheel, of any electric vehicle, any all-electric vehicle, or any hybrid vehicle, which can be used to power, to propel, or to facilitate the propulsion or movement of the respective electric vehicle, all-electric vehicle, or hybrid vehicle.

[0114] With reference to the FIG. **9A**, the apparatus **300** is shown and illustrated with each of switch **40** and Power On switch **51** in the “OPEN” or “OFF” positions, wherein the vehicle battery **10** is disconnected from, and not capable of providing electricity to, the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120** and to the vehicle non-drain loads **30**, and wherein the Power On switch **51** prevents any electricity from being provided, from any battery or power source, to the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120** and to the vehicle non-drain loads **30**.

[0115] With reference to FIG. **9B**, the switch **40** is shown in the “CLOSED” or “ON” position, wherein the vehicle battery **10** can be connected to, and can be capable of providing electricity to, the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120** and to the vehicle non-drain loads **30** if and when the Power On switch **51** is switched to the “CLOSED” or “ON” position. With reference to FIG. **9C**, each of switch **40** and Power On switch **51** are shown in the “CLOSED” or “ON” positions wherein the vehicle battery **10** is connected to, and provides electricity to, the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120** and to the vehicle non-drain loads **30**.

[0116] FIGS. **10A** and **10B** each illustrate a preferred embodiment mechanism for recharging the vehicle battery and the vehicle auxiliary battery of an electric vehicle, an all-electric vehicle, and/or a hybrid vehicle, by driving the alternator(s) **80** of the apparatus **300** with and using any suitable rotating component of a respective and suitable component of the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120**.

[0117] FIG. **10A** illustrates a preferred embodiment mechanism which includes a rotating shaft **81**, which is a component of the alternator(s) **80** of FIGS. **9A**, **9B**, and **9C**, a rotating shaft **110**, which is a component of the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120** of FIGS. **9A**, **9B**, and **9C**, and a fan belt **130**. In a preferred embodiment, the fan belt **130** is driven by the rotating shaft **110** and, in turn, drives the rotation of the rotating shaft **81** which results in the generation of the electricity or the electrical power, by the alternator(s) **80**, which electricity or electrical power is used to recharge the vehicle battery **10** and the vehicle auxiliary battery **60**. In a preferred embodiment, the rotating shaft **81** provides the necessary rotation and/or rotational motion or energy which is needed by and used by the alternator(s) **80** to generate the electricity or the electrical power which is, or can be, used to recharge the vehicle battery **10** and the auxiliary vehicle battery **60** as the respective electric vehicle, all-electric vehicle, or hybrid vehicle, is operating.

[0118] With reference to FIG. **10A**, the rotating shaft **81** has a recessed portion **82** (shown in dotted lines) which can facilitate a more secure seating or housing of the fan belt **130** within and/or on rotating shaft **81**. As and for an example, the rotating shaft **81** can, in a preferred embodiment, be

formed or molded in a cross section like a clothesline pulley so that the fan belt **130** can be situated between the sidewalls of the same in and during operation. With reference to FIG. **10A**, the rotating shaft **110** also has a recessed portion **111** (shown in dotted lines) which can also facilitate a more secure seating or housing of the fan belt **130** within and/or on the rotating shaft **110**. As and for an example, the rotating shaft **110** can, in a preferred embodiment, also be formed or molded in a cross section like a clothesline pulley so that the fan belt **130** can be situated between the sidewalls of the same in and during operation. In a preferred embodiment, the fan belt **130** should be secured tightly about the between the rotating shaft **81** and the rotating shaft **110** so as to prevent slippage of the fan belt **130**, and so as to ensure that the rotational energy of the rotating shaft **110** is transferred to the rotating shaft **81** in an optimal and efficient manner.

[0119] In a preferred embodiment, the fan belt **130**, which is utilized in the apparatus of FIGS. **99A**, **9B**, **9C**, and **10A**, can be of the type or kind which is similar to, or analogous to, conventional vehicle fan belts which are used to drive alternators or air conditioner system components in internal combustion engine vehicles. In another preferred embodiment, the fan belt **130**, and/or the recessed portions **82**, of the rotating shaft **81**, and the recessed portions **111**, of the rotating shafts **110**, can be provided with corresponding grooves, serrations, or other traction inducing formations, which can prevent slippage of the fan belt **130**. In another preferred embodiment, the fan belt **130** can be implemented with a chain of metal, plastic, or any other suitable material, and the the recessed portions **82**, of the rotating shaft **81**, and the recessed portions **111**, of the rotating shafts **110**, can be provided with corresponding sprocket-like protrusions (in a manner similar to a bicycle chain and sprocket system) in order to prevent slippage of the fan belt **130** on or about the rotating shaft **81** and or the rotating shaft **110**.

[0120] With reference to FIG. **10A**, once the fan belt **130** is adequately secured about both the rotating shaft **110** and the rotating shaft **81**, the rotation of the rotating shaft **110** will drive the rotation of the rotating shaft **81**.

[0121] In a preferred embodiment, any suitable and/or appropriate design technique(s) can be utilized to provide the rotating shaft **81** and the rotating shaft **110** of FIG. **10A** so that the fan belt **130**, which is to be driven by the rotating shaft **110**, which is a rotating component of the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120** or any suitable component of same, can drive the rotation of the rotating shaft **81**.

[0122] In a preferred embodiment, the rotating shaft **110** can be a component of any suitable component of the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120**. In a preferred embodiment, the rotating shaft **110** can be a component of a vehicle electric motor, an in-wheel motor, a transmission, a differential, an axle, a spindle, a reduction gear, a reducer, an axle, or a wheel, of the respective electric vehicle, all-electric vehicle, or hybrid vehicle. In a preferred embodiment, the rotating shaft **110** can be a component of a vehicle electric motor or an in-wheel motor. In another preferred embodiment, the rotating shaft **110** can be a component of a transmission. In another preferred embodiment, the rotating shaft **110** can be a component of a differential. In another preferred embodiment, the rotating shaft **110** can be a component of an axle. In another preferred embodiment, the rotating shaft **110** can be a component of a spindle. In another preferred embodiment, the rotating shaft **110** can be a component of a reduction gear. In another preferred embodiment, the rotating shaft **110** can be a component of a reducer. In another preferred embodiment, the rotating shaft **110** can be a component of an axle. In another preferred embodiment, the rotating shaft **110** can be a component of a wheel. In another preferred embodiment, the rotating shaft **110** can be any rotating component of the respective electric vehicle, all-electric vehicle, or hybrid vehicle.

[0123] In another preferred embodiment, for any single electric vehicle, all-electric vehicle, or hybrid vehicle, any number of rotating shafts **81**, rotating shafts **110**, and fan belts **130**, can be utilized or employed in, on, with, or in conjunction with, any number of multiple components of the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120** of the respective electric vehicle, all-electric

vehicle, or hybrid vehicle, and/or any number of rotating shafts **81**, rotating shafts **110**, and fan belts **130**, can be utilized or employed at multiple locations of, in, on, with, or in conjunction with, any one or single rotating component of the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120** of the respective electric vehicle, all-electric vehicle, or hybrid vehicle.

[0124] With reference once again to FIG. **10A**, the mechanism disclosed therein can be used to generate electricity or electrical power in the following manner. When the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system is operating and/or when the vehicle is in motion, the rotation of the rotating shaft **110** (of the respective component of the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120**) will, via the fan belt **130**, drive the rotation of the rotating shaft **81**. The rotation of the rotating shaft **81** will drive the alternator(s) **80** and the alternator(s) **80** will generate electricity which is used to recharge the vehicle battery **10** and the vehicle auxiliary battery **60**.

[0125] FIG. **10B** illustrates a cross section of another preferred embodiment mechanism for driving a rotating shaft of the alternator(s) **80** so as to generate electricity which is used to recharge the vehicle battery **10** and the vehicle auxiliary battery **60**.

[0126] With reference to FIG. **10B**, the rotating shaft **81A**, which is a component of the alternator(s) **80**, is shown situated coaxially within the rotating shaft **110A** of the respective component of the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120**. With reference to FIG. **10B**, the rotating shaft **110A** has an inner surface **110B** as shown. In a preferred embodiment, the rotating shaft **81A** is fastened to the inner surface **110B** of the rotating shaft **110A** via connecting member **110C** as shown. In the mechanism of FIG. **10B**, as the rotating shaft **110A** rotates, the connecting member **110C** causes the rotating shaft **81A** to rotate in the same direction as the rotation of the rotating shaft **110A**. Although shown as rotating clockwise, it is important to note that rotating shaft **110A** can also rotate counterclockwise, and when such is the case, the rotating shaft **81A** would also rotate counterclockwise along with the rotating shaft **110C**.

[0127] With reference once again to FIG. **10B**, the mechanism disclosed therein can be used to generate electricity or electrical power in the following manner. When the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system is operating and/or when the vehicle is in motion, the rotation of the rotating shaft **110A** (of the respective component of the electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120**) will, via the connecting member **110C**, drive the rotation of the rotating shaft **81A**. The rotation of the rotating shaft **81A** will drive the alternator(s) **80** and the alternator(s) **80** will generate electricity which is used to recharge the vehicle battery **10** and the vehicle auxiliary battery **60**.

[0128] In another preferred embodiment, the apparatus **300** and/or the recharging mechanisms of FIGS. **10A** and/or **10B** can also be utilized along with remote control circuitry and/or remote control components which can be utilized in order to remotely open or to remotely close each of the main cutoff switch **40** and the Power On switch **51**, and/or to monitor or to control the battery power management functions or functionalities of the apparatus and methods of the present invention.

[0129] FIG. **11** illustrates another preferred embodiment of the apparatus of the present invention which is designated by the reference number **400**. With reference to FIG. **11**, the apparatus **400** includes, in place of a vehicle ignition system **20**, an electric vehicle motor/propulsion system **120**. With reference to FIG. **11**, the apparatus **400** can include a transmitter **42**, which can be any type or kind of remote control transmitter for opening or closing the circuit controlled by the main cutoff switch **40** and which, in a preferred embodiment, can be integrated into and/or with a vehicle remote control device, a key chain, or a key fob, or any other device, a receiver **44** located at, in, or on, the vehicle, for receiving a signal, signals, or sequence of signals, transmitted from the transmitter **42** and indicative of a main shutoff switch opening operation or a main cutoff switch closing operation, a controller **46** for processing any signal, signals, or sequence of signals, received by the receiver **44**, and an electronically activated switching device **48** which can be located in parallel with the main cutoff switch **40**, which can serve to close or open the circuit controlled by

the main cutoff switch **40**. In a preferred embodiment, the electronically activated switching device **48** can be placed in parallel with the main cutoff switch **40** so that it can simply bypass the main cutoff switch **40** in a preferred embodiment.

[0130] With reference once again to FIG. **11**, the apparatus **400** can include a transmitter **52**, which can be any type or kind of remote control transmitter for opening or closing the circuit controlled by the Power On switch **51** and which, in a preferred embodiment, can also be integrated into and/or with a vehicle remote control device, a key chain, or a key fob, or any other device, a receiver **54** located at, in, or on, the vehicle, for receiving a signal, signals, or sequence of signals, transmitted from the transmitter **52** and indicative of a vehicle Power On switch **51** opening operation or a Power On switch **51** closing operation, a controller **56** for processing any signal, signals, or sequence of signals, received by the receiver **54**, and an electronically activated switching device **58** which can be located in parallel with the Power On switch **51**, which can serve to close or open the circuit controlled by the Power On switch **51**. In a preferred embodiment, the electronically activated switching device **58** can be placed in parallel with the Power On switch **51** so that it can simply bypass the Power On switch **51** in a preferred embodiment.

[0131] In a preferred embodiment, the transmitter **42** and/or the transmitter **52** can also be implemented by, replaced by, or used in conjunction with, a central processing computer or an Internet server **200** (hereinafter “central processing computer **200**”), which can be associated with a web site. In another preferred embodiment, any authorized user or authorized person can utilize any suitable communication device **250**, which, in a preferred embodiment, can be a personal computer, a tablet, a tablet computer, a laptop computer, a notebook computer, a cellular telephone, a wireless telephone, a personal digital assistant, or any other suitable device, in order to transmit any respective signal, signals, or sequence of signals, to the respective receiver **44** and/or to the respective receiver **54** via the central processing computer **200** on, over, or via, the Internet and/or the World Wide Web, and/or on or over any other communication network(s), wireless communication network(s), or any combination of same. In this regard, in a preferred embodiment, any authorized user or authorized person can use or control the apparatus **100** of the present invention on, over, or via, the Internet and/or the World Wide Web and/or any other communication network(s), wireless communication network(s), or any combination of same.

[0132] In another preferred embodiment, the apparatus **300** of FIGS. **9A**, **9B**, and **9C** can also be utilized along with any number of alternators and/or generators in order to recharge the vehicle battery **10** and the vehicle auxiliary battery **60**. FIG. **12** illustrates another preferred embodiment of the apparatus of the present invention which is designated by the reference numeral **500**. With reference to FIG. **12**, the apparatus **500** includes, in place of alternator(s) **80**, alternator(s)/generators **85**.

[0133] In another preferred embodiment, the apparatus **400** of FIG. **11** can also be utilized along with any number of alternators and/or generators in order to recharge the vehicle battery **10** and the vehicle auxiliary battery **60**. FIG. **13** illustrates another preferred embodiment of the apparatus of the present invention which is designated by the reference numeral **600**. With reference to FIG. **13**, the apparatus **600** includes, in place of alternator(s) **80**, alternator(s)/generators **85**.

[0134] In another preferred embodiment, as well as in any and/or all of the embodiments described herein, the apparatus and methods of the present invention can also be utilized in, on, and/or in connection with, and/or in conjunction with, vehicles of any kinds, types, or sizes, including, but not limited to, vehicles which require, or which may require, a driver, an operator, or a pilot, self-driving vehicles, autonomous vehicles, and/or remote-controlled vehicles, any of which vehicles can also be land vehicles, air vehicles, and/or sea vehicles or marine vehicles, of any kind, type, or size, and including, but not limited to, automobiles, cars, trucks, buses, trains, subway trains, aircraft, airplanes, jets, helicopters, drones, spacecraft, and/or satellites, and/or water vehicles or marine vehicles, boats, ships, submarines, and/or submersible vehicles, or any kind, type, or size.

[0135] In this regard, in a preferred embodiment, the apparatus and methods of the present

invention can be utilized in, on, and/or in connection with, and/or in conjunction with, vehicles of any kinds, types, or sizes, including, but not limited to, vehicles which require, or which may require, a driver, an operator, or a pilot, self-driving vehicles, autonomous vehicles, and/or remote-controlled vehicles. Further, the apparatus and methods of the present invention can also be utilized in, on, and/or in connection with, and/or in conjunction with, land vehicles, air vehicles, and/or sea vehicles or marine vehicles, of any kind, type, or size. Still further, the apparatus and methods of the present invention can also be utilized in, on, and/or in connection with, and/or in conjunction with, automobiles, cars, trucks, buses, trains, subway trains, aircraft, airplanes, jets, helicopters, drones, spacecraft, and/or satellites, and/or water vehicles or marine vehicles, boats, ships, submarines, and/or submersible vehicles, or any kind, type, or size.

[0136] While the present invention has been described and illustrated in various preferred and alternate embodiments, such descriptions are merely illustrative of the present invention and are not to be construed to be limitations thereof. In this regard, the present invention encompasses all modifications, variations, and/or alternate, embodiments, with the scope of the present invention being limited only by the claims which follow.

Claims

1. An apparatus, comprising: a first circuit, wherein the first circuit contains a first load, wherein a first battery is associated with the first circuit, and further wherein the first load comprises an electric motor of an electric vehicle or a hybrid vehicle; a second circuit, wherein the second circuit contains a second load, wherein the second load draws current from a second battery when the first load is not operating or is non-operational; a first switch, wherein the first switch is capable of disconnecting the first battery from the first circuit; a second switch, wherein the second switch is capable of connecting the first battery to the first circuit, wherein the first switch and the second switch are connected in series; at least one recharger, wherein the at least one recharger recharges the first battery and the second battery when the first load is operating; a third circuit, wherein the third circuit contains a second battery; and a third load, wherein the third load is connected between the first circuit and the third circuit, and further wherein the third load generates a circuit stabilizing voltage drop.
2. The apparatus of claim 1, further comprising: a receiver, wherein the receiver receives a signal transmitted from a remote control device or a wireless device, wherein the apparatus opens the first switch in response to the signal, or wherein the apparatus closes the first switch in response to the signal.
3. The apparatus of claim 1, further comprising: a receiver, wherein the receiver receives a signal transmitted from a central processing computer, wherein the signal is transmitted over the Internet or the World Wide Web to the receiver, and further wherein the apparatus opens the first switch in response to the signal, or wherein the apparatus closes the first switch in response to the signal.
4. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the first switch is a cut-off switch.
5. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the second switch is a switch associated with the electric motor of the electric vehicle or the hybrid vehicle.
6. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the first load further comprises: a differential.
7. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the electric motor is an in-wheel motor.
8. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the first load further comprises: an electric power control unit.
9. The apparatus of claim 1, further comprising: a first rotating shaft, wherein the first rotating shaft is a component of the electric motor, a transmission, a reduction gear, a reducer, an axle, an axle, or a wheel; and a second rotating shaft, wherein the second rotating shaft is a component of the at least one recharger, wherein the first rotating shaft drives a rotation of the second rotating shaft.
10. The apparatus of claim 9, further comprising: a fan belt, wherein the fan belt is attached to the first rotating shaft and the second rotating shaft, and further wherein the fan belt causes the second

rotating shaft to rotate in response to a rotation of the first rotating shaft.

11. The apparatus of claim 9, further comprising: a connecting member, wherein the connecting member is connected to each of the first rotating member and the second rotating member, and further wherein the connecting member causes the second rotating member to rotate in response to a rotation of the first rotating shaft.

12. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein the second rotating shaft is coaxial with the first rotating shaft.

13. The apparatus of claim 9, further comprising: a chain, wherein the chain interacts with a sprocket on the first rotating shaft and a sprocket on the second rotating shaft, and further wherein the chain causes the second rotating shaft to rotate in response to a rotation of the first rotating shaft.

14. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the at least one recharger is an alternator or a plurality of alternators, or wherein the at least one recharger is a generator or a plurality of generators.

15. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the first load comprises a plurality of electric motors of the electric vehicle or the hybrid vehicle.

16. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the electric vehicle or the hybrid vehicle is a land vehicle, an air vehicle, a sea vehicle, a marine vehicle, and further wherein the electric vehicle or the hybrid vehicle is a self-driving vehicle, an autonomous vehicle, or a remote-controlled vehicle.

17. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the first load further comprises: power electronics; and a transmission, wherein the transmission is a reducer.

18. The apparatus of claim 1, further comprising: the first battery; and the second battery.

19. An apparatus, comprising: a first circuit, wherein the first circuit contains a first load, wherein a first battery is associated with the first circuit; a second circuit, wherein the second circuit contains a second load, wherein the second load draws current from a second battery when the first load is not operating or is non-operational; a first switch, wherein the first switch is capable of disconnecting the first battery from the first circuit; a second switch, wherein the second switch is capable of connecting the first battery to the first circuit, wherein the first switch and the second switch are connected in series; at least one recharger, wherein the at least one recharger recharges the first battery and the second battery when the first load is operating; a third circuit, wherein the third circuit contains a second battery; and a third load, wherein the third load is connected between the first circuit and the third circuit.

20. The apparatus of claim 19, wherein the first load comprises an electric motor of an electric vehicle or a hybrid vehicle, and further wherein the third load generates a circuit stabilizing voltage drop.
